

Resource: Sustainability

Resource: Sustainability at St. Thomas

Sustainability

Sustainability is central to the University's mission of advancing the common good. We envision sustainability as fostering interconnected human and environmental well-being now and for future generations. Each individual and every field of study has something unique and important to offer to this effort.

The University of St. Thomas infuses sustainability into academic programs, student life, facilities, dining and campus operations. This work is grounded in our identity as a Catholic university and embraces the principles of caring for creation, environmental stewardship, and advancing the common good on a shared planet. Our sustainability vision is to "catalyze university-wide engagement to create a culture that prepares students to be sustainability leaders during their university years and beyond."

Office of Sustainability Initiatives

The [Office of Sustainability Initiatives](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/78022/sustainability-home) 

(<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/78022/sustainability-home>).(OSI)

partners with units across the University to create a culture of sustainability on campus that prepares students to be sustainability leaders and collaborators during their university years and beyond.

Meet the Office of Sustainability Initiatives Team



Dr. Maria Dahmus, Director, Office of Sustainability Initiatives, medahmus@stthomas.edu
(<mailto:medahmus@stthomas.edu>)

Rachel Schauer, Program Manager, Office of Sustainability Initiatives, rschauer@stthomas.edu
(<mailto:rschauer@stthomas.edu>)

The [Student Sustainability Leadership Program](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/168000/sslp) ➞

(<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/168000/sslp>) (SSLP) is a team of student leaders who increase student sustainability knowledge and action through peer-education. Student Sustainability Leaders bring hands-on education to the campus community through programs including educational activities and events, [Trash Talking](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePage/131191/trash-talking-request-form) ➞ (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePage/131191/trash-talking-request-form>), [Tommies Closet](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePage/166265/tommies-closet) ➞ (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePage/166265/tommies-closet>), and more!

Get Involved with Sustainability at St. Thomas

- **Partner with SSLP**

Student Sustainability Leaders are available to partner with your group to provide sustainability education and activities. Student leaders provide information on campus sustainability topics including waste reduction, transportation options, and more! If you are interested in partnering with SSLP, [please fill out the request form](https://forms.office.com/r/WDCAh9N5Sx) ➞ (<https://forms.office.com/r/WDCAh9N5Sx>). Visit the Student Sustainability Leaders in their office ASC 318 (located inside the Leadership Center) to learn how you can get involved with sustainability on campus.



- **Campus Sustainability Month (October)**

Campus Sustainability Month ➞

(<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/96509/campus-sustainability-month>) is a celebration of sustainability in higher education. Throughout the month, colleges and universities raise visibility around sustainability solutions and engage students and employees in initiatives to create a better world for present and future generations. Events will be posted on **OneStThomas** ➞ (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/96509/campus-sustainability-month>) and **Tommie Link** ➞ (<https://stthomas.campuslabs.com/engage/organization/osi>) so check back soon!

- **Sustainability Week (April)**

Each year, **Sustainability Week** ➞

(<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/165796/sustainability-week>) is celebrated during the week of Earth Day (April 22). Departments and organizations across campus host events to invite campus community members to explore sustainability initiatives and celebrate Earth Day together. Be on the lookout for the Sustainability Week schedule of events during spring semester!

• Organics Recycling

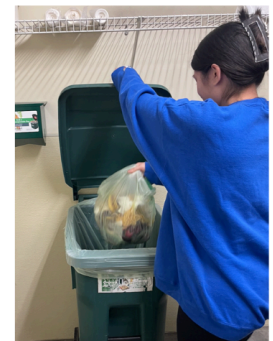
We are excited to share that every residence room has an organics recycling container! This container can be used to collect items that are [accepted for organics recycling](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/facilities-management/recycling/SitePageModern/183249/organics-recycling)  (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/facilities-management/recycling/SitePageModern/183249/organics-recycling>) including all food scraps, napkins, and products with the BPI certified logo.

Please collect these items in a green BPI certified bag that is provided in the waste rooms on each floor. When the container is full, tie the bag and bring it to the waste room. Drop the bag in the large organics recycling bin and take another bag with you to replace it in your container.

Organics Recycling

Organics recycling is an important way to divert valuable organic material from the waste stream.

At St. Thomas, the organic material is collected and brought to a commercial compost facility that turns the material into compost. Compost is a nutrient-rich soil amendment that can be used in gardens and lawns!



Items accepted for Organics Recycling

- All food scraps
- Napkins & paper towels
- BPI certified products
 - Dining Services provides compostable coffee cups, utensils, and paper to-go containers. Double check for a BPI certified logo!
- Coffee grounds & filters, paper tea bags, plant & flower trimmings, wood chopsticks & skewers, toothpicks, pizza boxes



Waste Sorting at St. Thomas



Powered by Panopto



- **Guide to Sustainable Living**

Looking for more ways to live sustainably on campus? Check out the [Guide to Sustainable Living](https://www.stthomas.edu/_media-library/_documents/residence-life/guide-to-sustainable-living.pdf)  (https://www.stthomas.edu/_media-library/_documents/residence-life/guide-to-sustainable-living.pdf) !

Get Connected

Interested in learning more? Connect with the Office of Sustainability Initiatives

Learn more about the [Office of Sustainability Initiatives](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/78022/sustainability-home)  (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/sustainability/SitePageModern/78022/sustainability-home>)

Email us at sustainability@stthomas.edu (<mailto:sustainability@stthomas.edu>)

Follow us on Instagram [@sustainablestthomas](https://www.instagram.com/sustainablestthomas)  (<https://www.instagram.com/sustainablestthomas/>)

View upcoming events on [Tommie Link](https://stthomas.campuslabs.com/engage/organization/osi)  (<https://stthomas.campuslabs.com/engage/organization/osi>)